

Mehidy Hasan Miraz (**right**) struck a century and claimed five wickets — becoming only the third Bangladeshi player to do so after Shakib Al Hasan and Sohag Gazi — as the host crushed Zimbabwe by an innings and 106 runs to level the two-match Test series. After scoring 104 in the first innings, Mehidy took five for 32 to bowl Zimbabwe out for 111 on day three. In the first Test, Zimbabwe's Blessing Muzarabani claimed six for 72 and Brian Bennett notched up a half-century to seal a three-wicket win over Bangladesh. Mehidy had given Bangladesh hope of victory by picking up five wickets on day four, but Zimbabwe's batters held their nerve to secure their first Test win since 2021.



AFP



RITU RAJ KONWAR

Pakistan and Bangladesh are set to play a five-match T20I series in May and June as part of their build-up to the 2026 T20 World Cup. The first two matches will be held in Faisalabad, which is hosting international cricket for the first time since 2008, with the remaining three games scheduled for Lahore. The T20 World Cup will be hosted by India and Sri Lanka in February and March next year.



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Ben Stokes is fit to return as England captain for its one-off Test against Zimbabwe later this month, having been named in a 13-man squad. The 33-year-old all-rounder has recovered from a hamstring injury sustained in New Zealand in December — his second hamstring tear in five months. Stokes is set to feature in England's opening Test of the home season. The four-day match, instead of the standard five-day format, will be held at Trent Bridge from May 22 to 25.